ARGUMENT AGAINST MEASURE Q

Measure Q asks Fairfield voters to change the City Clerk from an elected position to one appointed by the City Manager or Council. This proposal would remove a direct line of accountability between the public and one of the City's most important offices - the keeper of official records, elections, and public transparency.

This measure does not raise taxes, but it reduces direct voter control over a core democratic function. Once changed, restoring an elected Clerk requires a new initiative and thousands of signatures - a difficult process.

An elected City Clerk serves the people, not politicians. Measure Q eliminates Fairfield's elected City Clerk and replaces it with an appointed position controlled by City Hall. This removes a key layer of public accountability. The Clerk's independence ensures that public records, election filings, and meeting documentation are handled impartially and openly. Turning this position into an appointment concentrates power within City Hall and weakens the checks and balances that protect residents from political influence. When the Clerk answers to the same officials whose actions must be recorded and disclosed, transparency suffers.

Supporters claim appointment will "professionalize" the office. But professionalism comes from qualifications and integrity, not from political control. Many California cities, including Dixon, recognize that voter accountability is the best safeguard for transparency. Fairfield should not move backward by eliminating that safeguard.

Measure Q also removes the public's ability to choose who manages election filings, campaign disclosures, and public records requests. These are core democratic functions that should remain under the oversight of voters, not under the supervision of those being monitored.

Fairfield residents deserve open government and independent record-keeping. The City Clerk's office belongs to the people, not to the politicians who want to appoint it.

Protect transparency. Protect accountability.

Vote NO on Measure Q.

Solano County Taxpayers Association
s/Michael T Nolan, President